Court or not is a different matter. But at any rate we should feel proud that our judiciary has proved so independent. It has given expression to its opinion in interpreting the provisions of the Constitution not in a manner which goes against the interest of the country but for securing the expanding rights and liberties of the people.

Shri Sidhva: What about the independence of the country?

Dr S.P. Mookerjee: The independence of the country will remain intact if you do not try to pass coercive measures. As the honourable Prime Minister said, no country can ever be governed by force or by coercion. If the country has run amuck, if there are people who could not be kept under control without exercising very strict executive rights and powers, then you must enquire why it is that the country has come to that state of affairs. Why should these people who were swearing by you only a year ago, condemn you today and why should it be necessary to find bullets and bayonets for keeping your freedom intact?

Shri Sidhva: For political purposes.

Dr S.P. Mookerjee: Mr Sidhva says for political purposes. I have said that I do not want more heat from the sand and I would like the heat from the Sun. So far as political power is concerned, I would say with all earnestness that very often it is our inability to probe into particular situations that create difficulties. We fail miserably to solve national problems and we want to gag and coerce people. I would specially remind the Prime Minister of the happenings at
Cooch-Behar a few days ago. I was myself there. I saw how India celebrated her first Jallianwala Bagh after her attaining freedom. I saw how there was [a] complete collapse of the administration there. The price of rice was shooting up from Rs 30 to Rs 70. About 56,000 *maunds* of rice were lying under the control of the local administration and not one *maund* of rice was released in time. The order for modified rationing came two hours before the bullets were used. Even that order was not communicated